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How to keep up with AI without losing your mind

Nobody can keep up with all of it. Not the people who build it, not me. The good news: you don't have to. You only have to keep up with the part that touches your work. This sheet is how.

THE THREE QUESTIONS

Before you spend any time on a piece of AI news, ask yourself:

Ship	Could I build something new or better because of this?
Work	Does this change how I do my job day to day?
Learn	Is this something I need to understand to stay relevant?

A yes on any one of the three means it matters. Three no's means it's entertainment. Read it if you want, enjoy it, it's not mandatory, and you won't fall behind if you skip it.

THE TWO SPEEDS

You can't follow everything closely. So follow a few things closely and everything else slowly.

Once a day: the few things you follow

Two or three companies or tools. Their official accounts only. Notifications on, so your phone tells you when something ships. When it does, try it that day on something real.

Once a week: everything else

One hour, once a week, on the calendar. Don't go looking in between. During the hour, skim what you saved and ask the three questions. If a story only shows up in one place, let it wait a week.

Total cost: a handful of notifications you choose, and about an hour a week.

IF YOU ONLY READ ONE THING, READ THIS

Five things to do Monday morning

1. **Pick two or three companies to follow.**
   The AI companies or tools you actually build on. For most people that's the one behind your coding assistant or Cowork, plus one more.
2. **Turn on their official notifications.**
   Only theirs. Turn everything else off. Page 5 shows you how.
3. **Block one hour a week.**
   Same day, same time, on your calendar. This is when you catch up on everything else.
4. **Try one new thing.**
   Real work. Pick a small real task and use a new tool on it this week. Not a tutorial.
5. **Write one decision, with a date.**
   What you decided, why, and when you'll revisit it: is the decision still correct? Page 3 is the form.

THEN, OVER THE NEXT MONTH

Week 1	Set up your two or three sources. Notifications on for them, off for everything else.
Week 2	Your first one-hour catch-up. Skim what you saved and ask the three questions.
Week 3	Your first try-out. One real task, one afternoon, one question written down first.
Week 4	Your first decision card. Put a date on it about three months out.

You're allowed to ignore most of this. That isn't you falling behind. That's the routine working.

WHEN THE TOOLS KEEP CHANGING

How to make decisions you won't regret

Nothing in this space is permanent. A tool you pick today might be worse, more expensive, or gone in three months. That's fine, as long as you planned for it.

THREE HABITS

Put a date on every decision.

When you decide to use a tool, write down why in one line and pick a date to look at it again. Three months out is a good default. When the date comes, actually look. If the tool is still the right call, keep it. If not, switch. Nobody has to feel bad, because you said you'd check.

Know your fallback.

For anything important, know what you'd do if the tool disappeared tomorrow. This isn't paranoia. In June 2026, Fable 5 was suspended three days after launch and stayed dark for nineteen days. People who had moved everything onto it were stuck.

Try before you read.

When something new comes out, don't spend two days reading reviews. Spend one afternoon using it on one real task from your backlog. Write down one question first: "What would make this a yes?" Then answer it. Keep it or drop it, and move on.

FOUR LISTS · TEN MINUTES A MONTH

Keep four short lists. Every time something passes the three questions, it goes on one. Once a month, spend ten minutes moving things between lists and crossing things off. Page 4 is the sheet.

Ignore
You saw it. It doesn't touch your work. Write it down so you stop rereading about it.

Watch
It might matter later. Not yet. Most things live here forever, and that's fine.

Trial
Worth an afternoon. Pick a real task and try it. Keep or drop.

Adopt
You use it. It has a decision card with a date on it.

WORDS YOU'LL HEAR

Model	The AI itself. Claude, GPT, and so on. The brain.
Harness	The tool you type into that uses the model. Claude Code, Codex, Copilot. The steering wheel.
Cowork	Same idea as a coding assistant, but for documents, email, spreadsheets, and research.
Release notes	The vendor's own list of what changed. The most boring and most useful thing you can read.
Deprecation	A warning that something you use is going away. Usually buried, always important.
Official source	The company's own account or page. Not a fan account, not a news site, not a repost.
Effort	How long the model thinks before it answers. More effort, better answers, slower and more usage.
AGI	An AI with real common sense. You'll see it in every launch; treat it as marketing until proven otherwise.

DECISION CARD · FILL ONE OUT EVERY TIME YOU START USING SOMETHING NEW

Half a page is on purpose. If it needs more room, you aren't sure yet.

DECISION CARD

date filled out: _____

What I decided to use

One sentence. "Switch my coding assistant to X."

Why

One line. The real reason, not the marketing one.

What I'll do if it goes away

The fallback. A tool, a model, or "go back to how I did it before."

Which list is it on?

☐ *Watch* ☐ *Trial* ☐ *Adopt*

Look at this again on

Three months from today is a good default. Put it on your calendar. The date is the part everyone skips. It's the only part that matters.

CUT HERE

DECISION CARD

date filled out: _____

What I decided to use

One sentence. "Switch my coding assistant to X."

Why

One line. The real reason, not the marketing one.

What I'll do if it goes away

The fallback. A tool, a model, or "go back to how I did it before."

Which list is it on?

☐ *Watch* ☐ *Trial* ☐ *Adopt*

Look at this again on

Three months from today is a good default. Put it on your calendar. The date is the part everyone skips. It's the only part that matters.

TEN MINUTES A MONTH

The four lists

How to use this: when something passes the three questions, write it in a column. Once a month, spend ten minutes. Cross off what stopped mattering. Move things left or right. Anything in Trial gets an afternoon. Anything in Adopt gets a decision card.

Ignore	Watch	Trial	Adopt
Saw it. Doesn't touch my work.	*Might matter later. Not yet.*	*Worth one afternoon on a real task.*	*Using it. Has a card with a date.*

Reviewed on: _____ Next review: _____ Most things never leave Watch. That's fine. Watching is free.

WHO TO FOLLOW

Where to look, and how to turn it on

Turn on notifications for the official accounts of the company you build on. Everything else waits for your weekly hour. If your company blocks these apps, run it all in the slow lane; you lose a few days of notice and nothing else.

FAST LANE · ACCOUNTS TO FOLLOW

Anthropic

@AnthropicAI company news and new models

@claudeai Claude, Claude Code and Cowork releases

@ClaudeDevs official developer updates

Claude Discord discord.com/invite/anthropic · announcements channel

OpenAI

@OpenAI company news and new models

@OpenAIDevs API and Codex updates

OpenAI Discord discord.com/invite/openai · announcements channel

YOUR WEEKLY HOUR · NO NOTIFICATIONS

People on X

Boris Cherny @bcherny built Claude Code. How he uses it, his teammates' tricks, straight answers when something's off.

Andrej Karpathy @karpathy new ideas explained in plain language.

Noam Brown @polynoamial reasoning research at OpenAI: what's changing in the models, and why.

Matt Pocock @mattpocockuk teaches practical AI coding, plus a plain-English dictionary of AI coding jargon.

Claude Code Changelog @ClaudeCodeLog `unofficial bot` every change in each release.

YouTube

Chase AI · WorldofAI · Claude and **OpenAI** (official channels)

Reddit

r/ClaudeAI · r/ClaudeCode · r/Anthropic · r/OpenAI · r/ChatGPT

Release notes

Claude and OpenAI release notes and changelogs. Every link is on the QR page.

WHAT USUALLY DOESN'T

Benchmark arguments. "X is dead" posts. Demos that aren't products yet. Anything with a leaderboard in the headline.

HOW TO TURN NOTIFICATIONS ON

On X

Open the account. Tap Follow. Tap the bell next to it and choose "All posts." Do this for your two or three only.

iPhone

Settings › Notifications › X › Allow Notifications on. Using a Focus? Add X to its allowed apps.

Android

Settings › Apps › X › Notifications on. Using Do Not Disturb? Add X as an exception.

Discord

Long-press the announcements channel (right-click on desktop) › Notification Settings › All Messages. Mute the rest of the server. Then turn on the master switch: gear icon › Notifications › Enable Desktop Notifications.

Every link, step by step, and my tips.

`mcreed87.github.io/keep-up-with-ai`

YOUR WEEKLY HOUR · A CHECKLIST

- Open whatever you saved during the week.
- Ask the three questions. Ten seconds each.
- Only in one place? Wait for a second source.
- If it passed, write it on one of the four lists.
- Close everything. Notifications stay off.

WHAT USUALLY MATTERS

Price or usage-limit changes. Changes to the tool you use every day. Anything being removed or "deprecated." Anything that changes your default setup.